



Discussion Guide: Paul Wallace

There's Something Holy Out There

Reflect

- Astrophysicist Neil deGrasse Tyson says that the more he looks at the reality of death and suffering in the universe, the less he thinks it is reasonable to believe in God. Paul responds by pointing to the miracle of existence itself, arguing that the sheer implausibility of our existence outweighs the evidence Tyson offers. Do you find this argument convincing? Why or why not?
- Paul contends that "When you see and love the beauty of the world, you see and love God." In what ways can recognizing beauty in the natural world lead you to a heightened awareness of or appreciation for God?
- In the midst of Job's trials, God responds to Job out of a whirlwind (chs. 38-41), offering him a stunning tour of the created world, from the ostrich to the stars of Orion. How was God's response to Job different from that of Job's three friends? Why do you think it succeeded in leading Job back to God?

Respond

- Paul talks about his heightened awareness of the beauty of creation during the experience of grief following his dad's death. Share an experience when you had a heightened awareness of beauty. Why do you think this circumstance enabled you to see or recognize beauty (or God) in ways you weren't able to before?
- In both the church and popular culture, faith and science are often seen as bitter rivals. We assume that being committed to one means we can't be committed to the other. Have you ever felt forced to choose between science and faith? How has Paul's talk changed how you think about the way in which science and faith might work together?